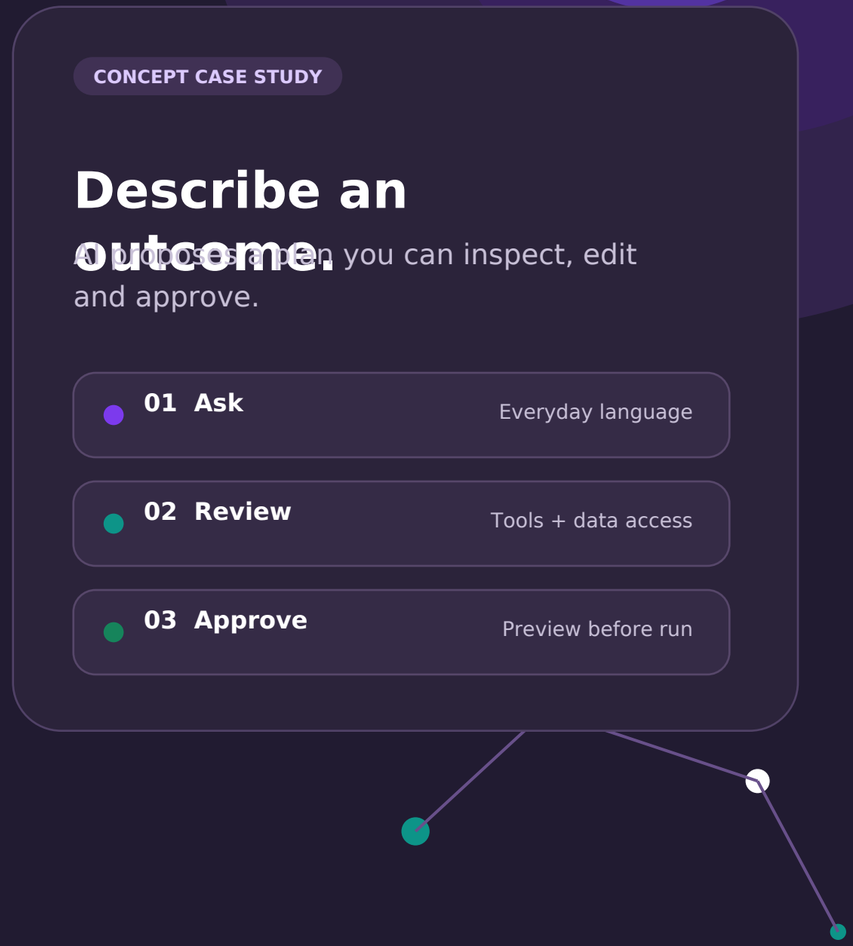
UX MENTORSHIP PROJECT

Pucho.ai

Trust-first AI automation

From “build me an automation” to “I understand what will happen.”



A concept study for the Pucho.ai UX mentorship brief

Scope: discovery • strategy • flows • interface concept • prototype • validation plan

Concept UI — not an official Pucho product interface

Design the first successful automation.

Help a non-technical business operator turn a repetitive task into a workflow they can understand before it runs.

THE CHALLENGE

Power without clarity creates hesitation.

AI automation can connect tools, interpret information and take multi-step actions. But when users cannot predict the outcome or understand what data will be touched, they hesitate to run it.

Design question

How might we make an AI workflow simple to start, transparent to inspect and safe to run?

TARGET USER

Non-technical operations manager at a small team

EXAMPLE JOB

Summarize new leads every morning and prepare a team digest

DESIGN SCOPE

First-time setup, plan review, permissions, preview and result

OUT OF SCOPE

Real integrations, production AI, and claims about shipped features

Project basis: Pucho.ai UX Mentorship Learning Project brief (provided PDF, pp. 2–5). This is a concept case study, not a claim of a live product redesign.

Make every design decision traceable.

The case study follows the required sequence: evidence → decisions → design → validation.

01

DISCOVER

Desk research + interview guide

02

DEFINE

Proto-persona + JTBD + HMW

03

STRUCTURE

Information architecture + flows

04

DESIGN

Wireframes + UI concept

05

VALIDATE

Prototype + usability plan

RESEARCH INTEGRITY

What is evidenced today

One initial proxy response recorded: a participant named “studying” as a repeated task.

What is still a hypothesis

Operations-manager pain points, remaining interview answers and usability outcomes are not yet verified.

How the concept proceeds

Use clear design hypotheses to build a testable prototype, then validate with real participants.

The project brief explicitly advises against manufacturing user evidence. This deck keeps assumptions and planned validation visible.

Ask about real behaviour, not feature wishes.

Use interviews to learn the steps, friction, trust checks and recovery needs in someone’s current process.

5-QUESTION INTERVIEW GUIDE

01 **What task do you repeat regularly in your work or studies?**

02 **How do you complete that task, from beginning to end?**

03 **What part takes the most time or causes frustration?**

04 **What would you check before trusting AI to do it?**

05 **If AI made a mistake, how would you want to correct it?**

RESEARCH PLAN

Participants

Aim for 4–5 people who manage repeatable admin tasks. One student can be a proxy participant, not a substitute for the target user.

Method

20–30 minute interviews; ask people to walk through a recent example.

Capture

Record notes with consent; remove names and confidential details.

Synthesis

Cluster repeated needs; separate direct quotes from interpretation.

The only participant response currently confirmed in this working conversation is the task “studying.” Remaining answers are not represented as collected evidence.

Separate the signal from the assumption.

A useful early-stage project can move forward while being transparent about what it does and does not know.

OBSERVED / CONFIRMED

One informal proxy response

Question: “What task do you repeat regularly in your daily work or studies?”

“Studying.”

This is a real response, but it comes from a student context rather than the target operations-manager context.

HYPOTHESES TO TEST

Potential needs, not findings

- **H1** People spend time extracting key points from long material.
- **H2** They want to verify accuracy before trusting an AI output.
- **H3** They want a clear way to edit or retry after a mistake.
- **H4** Operations users may need to inspect app access before a workflow runs.

Do not present H1–H4 as interview insights until participants actually confirm them. Use them to guide the next interview round.

Learn from the category without claiming a winner.

Desk research on official public product pages; this is a feature-and-positioning scan, not a measured usability test.

PUCHO.AI

Prompt-to-workflow

Public pages describe AI agents, visual workflows, connected tools and human-in-the-loop modes.

DESIGN TAKEAWAY

Opportunity: explain the proposed plan and access in a novice-friendly review.

www.pucho.ai/documentation/product-overview/pucho-platform

ZAPIER

Trigger + action

Official help explains workflows as triggers followed by one or more actions across connected apps.

DESIGN TAKEAWAY

Opportunity: show the user what starts the automation and what changes next.

help.zapier.com/hc/en-us/articles/8496309697421-What-is-a-Zap

MAKE

Visual orchestration

Official product pages emphasise a visual-first builder, AI-assisted setup and visible data flows.

DESIGN TAKEAWAY

Opportunity: use visual sequence, but keep labels understandable without technical terms.

www.make.com/en/product

n8n

Inspectable runs

Official AI-agent pages describe reviewing step inputs/outputs, replaying runs and setting human actions.

DESIGN TAKEAWAY

Opportunity: make audit, failure and recovery available in plain language.

n8n.io/ai-agents/

Design white space: Make automation inspectable, explainable and reversible without showing unnecessary technical complexity.

Source pages accessed 27 Oct 2026. See the reference list in the appendix. Product claims are attributed to official pages and are not independent performance claims.

Design for the outcome-focused operator.

This proto-persona is a design tool to test, not a research-validated representation of all operations managers.



Nisha

Operations manager · 15-person team

“I know the process. I do not want to become an automation engineer.”

PROTO-PERSONA

Confidence comes from understanding what the system will do before it does it.

GOAL	**Reduce repetitive work and keep the team informed.**
FRUSTRATION	**Too many technical choices before seeing the outcome.**
NEED	**Preview, clear permissions, meaningful approval points.**
SUCCESS	**A workflow that is easy to inspect, edit and recover.**

Scenario adapted from the supplied project brief. All persona details beyond the brief are explicit design assumptions pending interviews with actual operations users.

Define the job before designing the interface.

The interface should help people achieve a safe outcome, not force them to learn platform primitives.

JOBS TO BE DONE

When new leads arrive across my tools, I want to summarize and prioritize them, so I can follow up efficiently without manually checking every record or worrying about unintended messages.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

AI automation tools can expose technical choices before users understand the outcome, data access or consequences.

Risk: users either abandon automation or run a workflow without fully understanding it.

HOW MIGHT WE...

...make AI automation simple to start, transparent to inspect and safe to run?

Design response: ask → propose → review → preview → run → recover.

JTBD and problem framing are proposed for this concept. Validate wording and priority with target users before final portfolio claims.

Five principles turn trust into interface behaviour.

Use these as a decision filter for every key screen and interaction.

01 Intent before configuration

Let people describe the outcome in their own words.

02 Explain before execute

Show what each step does and why it exists.

03 Preview before commit

Let users inspect a realistic example before running.

04 Human control at critical moments

Require approval for external or high-impact actions.

05 Recover without fear

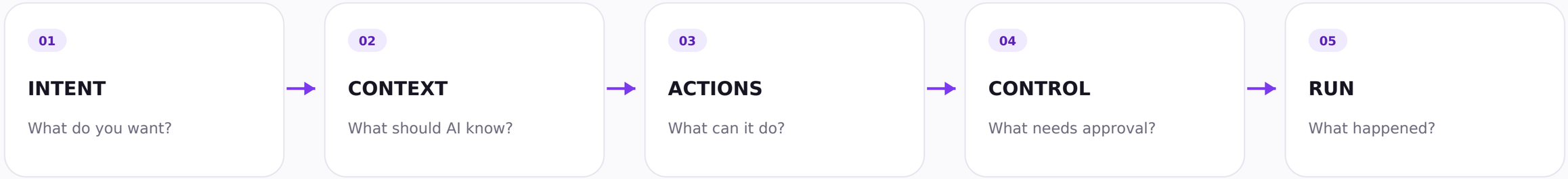
Explain failures and make edit, retry and pause visible.

At every moment, answer: What is happening? Why? What can I do about it?

The principles align with the brief’s emphasis on understandable AI actions, control checkpoints, preview and recovery.

Organise the product around the user’s outcome.

Expose the next useful decision first; keep complex settings available when needed.



NAVIGATION MODEL

Build	Create and review new automations	**Agents**	Reusable assistants	**Workflows**	Saved multi-step automations
Knowledge	Approved reference material	**Connections**	Apps and data permissions	**Runs**	History, errors and recovery

Information architecture is a proposed concept structure. Validate labels and grouping with card sorting or tree testing where feasible.

A guided conversation, not a configuration form.

The key transition is AI proposal → human understanding.

1 **Describe outcome**
Everyday language

→

2 **AI proposes plan**
Steps + reasons

→

3 **Review access**
Tools + data

→

4 **Preview result**
Expected output

→

5 **Run / approve**
Human control

→

6 **Inspect result**
Recover if needed

AI responsibilities

Interpret intent • draft plan • summarize routine information • report execution status

User responsibilities

Confirm criteria • inspect permissions • approve external actions • correct or retry failures

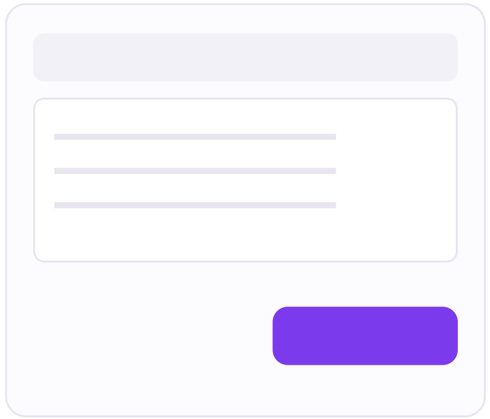
Designed happy path. Edge cases—missing connection, low confidence, tool failure and incorrect output—are addressed in the next sections.

Four core screens answer four user questions.

Sketch the structure first; visual polish comes only after the decision flow makes sense.

01 / ASK

What do I want?



Outcome + constraints

Build plan

02 / PLAN

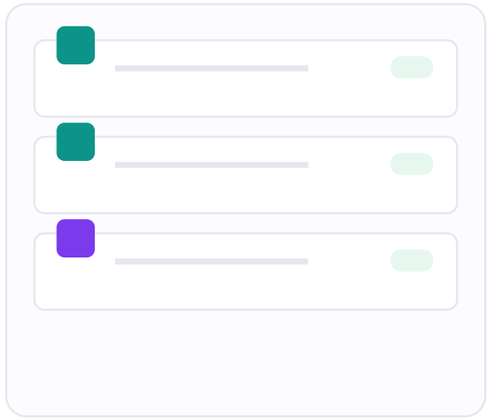
What will happen?

AI steps + rationale

Review access

03 / REVIEW

What can it access?

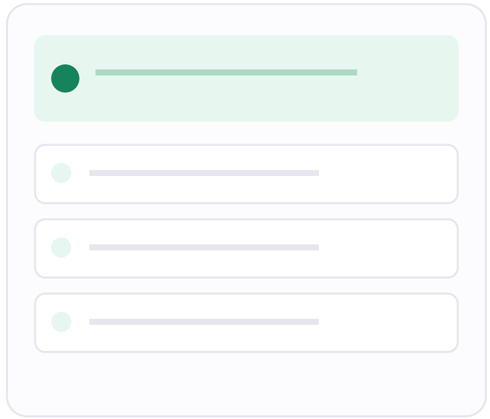


Tools + permissions

Preview

04 / RUN

What happened?



Status + run details

Wireframes show hierarchy and task purpose rather than final details. The clickable concept prototype develops these layouts into higher-fidelity screens.

A calm visual system for a complex product.

The workflow carries the visual interest; typography, spacing and colour make status and control easy to scan.

PRIMARY	INK	SURFACE	SUCCESS	RISK	REVIEW
#7C3AED	#171521	#FAF9FC	#16845B	#D94B68	#A7650D

TYPOGRAPHY

Aa Outcome first

A readable sans serif with clear hierarchy.

32 px	20 px	14 px	11 px
Page title	Section title	Body	Supporting text

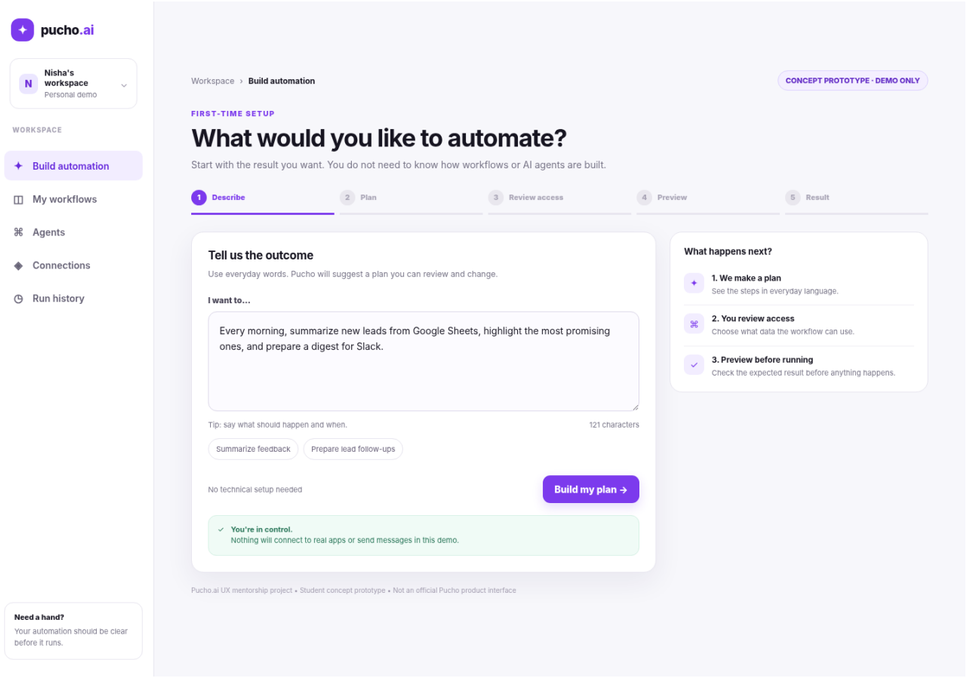
TOKENS + COMPONENTS

8 / 16 / 24 / 32	Spacing scale
12–16 px	Card radius
1 px	Borders
Button / Toggle / Status chip	Reusable controls

Visual tokens are proposed for this case study; they are not represented as Pucho’s official design system.

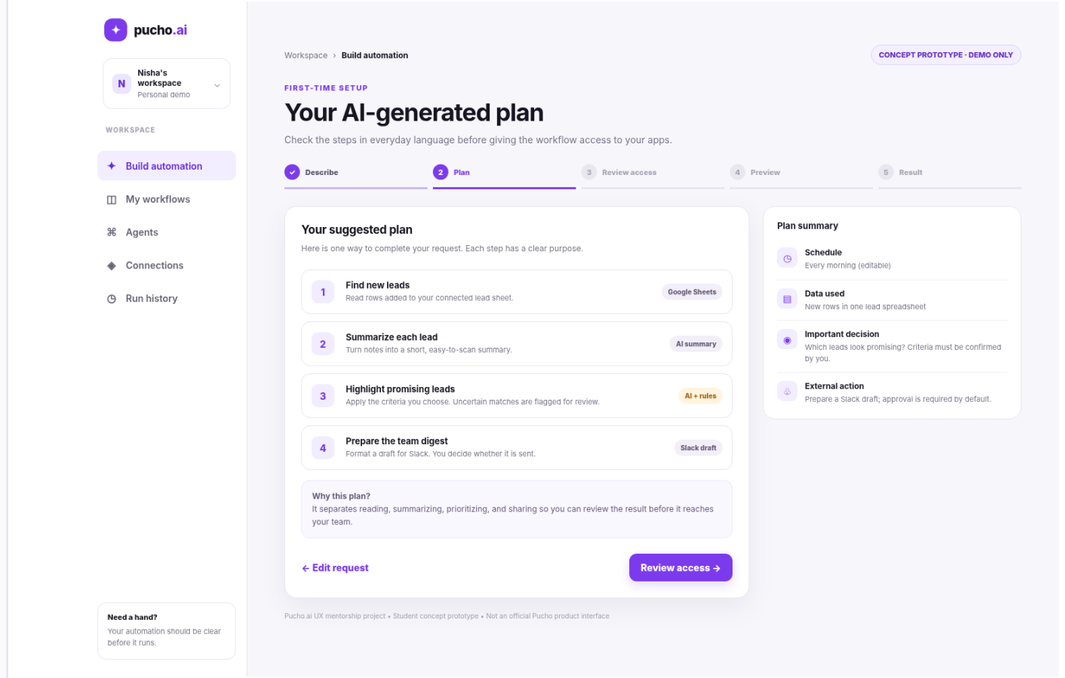
Concept 01 — Ask, don’t configure.

Start with the business outcome, then show a plan the user can inspect and change.



ASK

Outcome in everyday language



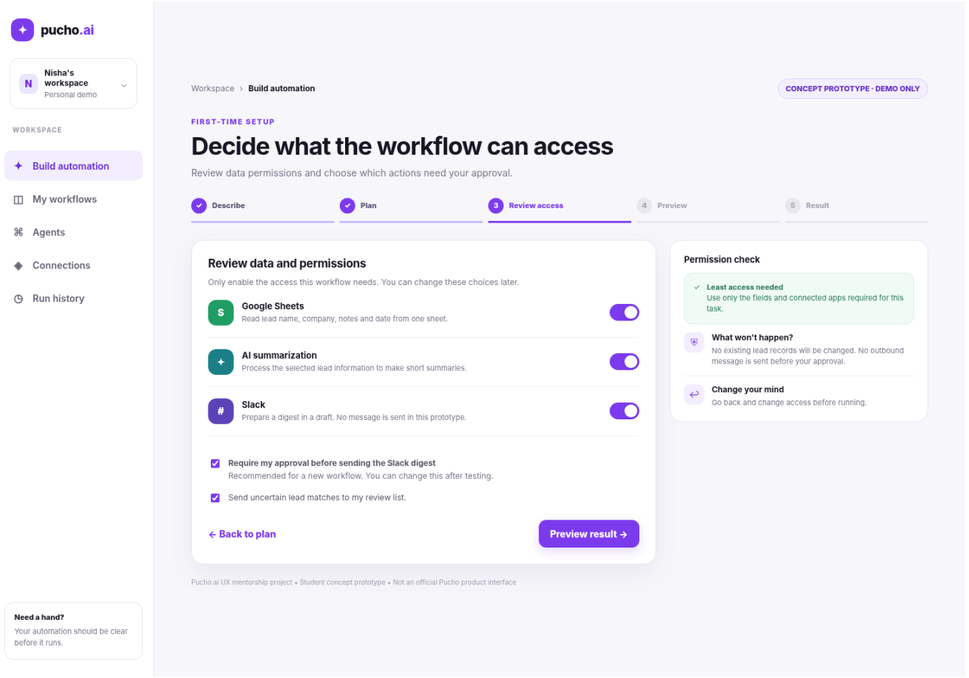
PLAN

Steps and reasons in plain language

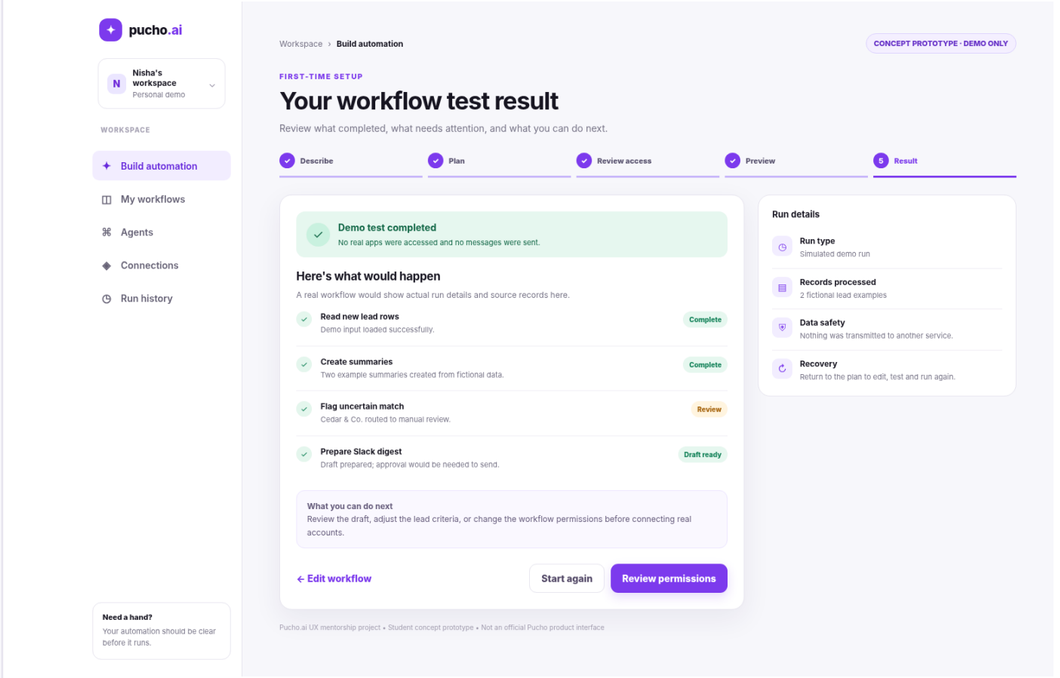
Prototype note: the “AI-generated” plan is scripted demo content, not a live model response. This prototype has no connected external accounts.

Concept 02 — Review access and inspect the result.

Keep permission decisions and post-run status visible at the moments when trust can break.



REVIEW — Access toggles + approval



RESULT — Run status + recovery

All screens are design concepts. The displayed lead records are fictional demo examples and the test run transmits no data.

Trust is tested when things go wrong.

Every error state should tell the user what happened, what is affected, and what they can do next.

TOOL FAILED

Name the failed connection and step. Offer retry or edit.

Retry step / reconnect

LOW CONFIDENCE

Avoid guessing. Explain what is missing and ask a question.

Clarify criteria

PERMISSION MISSING

Show the exact access needed and why.

Review permissions

WRONG OUTPUT

Let the user edit, rerun a safe step or discard the draft.

Edit / retry

Control contract: AI can propose and prepare routine steps. The user sets criteria, reviews scope and approves consequential external actions.

These are proposed edge-case behaviours to test in a prototype. No production error-handling implementation is claimed.

Test trust as a behaviour, not a survey score alone.

Run three task-based sessions with representative users, then revise the prototype based on observed behaviour.

TASK 01

Build a workflow from a plain-language request.

Can the user start without technical help?

TASK 02

Review the plan and permissions before a demo run.

Can the user explain what data is read and what action happens next?

TASK 03

Recover after one simulated tool failure.

Can the user find a safe next step without losing the whole workflow?

TEST SETUP

Participants

5–8 representative users if feasible

Format

Think aloud, 20–30 minutes

Capture

Hesitation, wrong assumptions, permission errors, recovery

Rule

Do not lead the participant or explain the answer

Current status: Test plan prepared. No usability sessions or observed outcomes have been completed yet.

Use consent, avoid collecting confidential business data, and document observations separately from interpretations.

Measure clarity, control and outcomes.

Success is not simply more automation. It is the right automation with an informed user.

ACTIVATION

Time to first working workflow

Lower setup friction

UNDERSTANDING

Can the user predict steps, inputs and outputs?

Informed control

TRUST

Approval behaviour and reported confidence

Appropriate autonomy

RELIABILITY

Successful runs and successful recovery

Workflow health

Baseline → test observation → design change → retest. Do not invent numeric improvements before measuring.

These are proposed measures. Set thresholds only after baseline usability sessions and an understanding of the context.

The UX story in one frame.

A strong case study links the user problem to a rationale, a design decision and a validation plan.

01

EVIDENCE

One proxy reported studying as a repeated task. Business user evidence is still missing.

02

INSIGHT / HYPOTHESIS

First-time users may need to see consequences before trusting automation.

03

OPPORTUNITY

Progressively reveal complexity; make tool access and AI decisions inspectable.

04

DESIGN

Ask → plan → review → preview → run → recover.

05

VALIDATION

Test comprehension, permission choices and recovery with target users.

Portfolio lesson

For AI UX, the interaction model is also a trust model: the user should understand what is happening, why it is happening, and how to intervene.

This case study is a concept proposal with research gaps explicitly identified. Complete target-user research and usability testing before claiming validated outcomes.

Sources, assumptions and research integrity.

Public product information is evidence about product positioning and advertised capabilities — not evidence about user behaviour.

PUBLIC SOURCES / OFFICIAL PAGES

Pucho.ai — Platform overview

https://www.pucho.ai/documentation/product-overview/pucho-platform

Pucho.ai — Homepage

https://www.pucho.ai/

Zapier — What is a Zap?

https://help.zapier.com/hc/en-us/articles/8496309697421-What-is-a-Zap

Make — Product

https://www.make.com/en/product

n8n — AI agents

https://n8n.io/ai-agents/

ASSUMPTIONS / LIMITATIONS

Proto-persona

Nisha is a proto-persona derived from the assignment scenario, not a validated segment.

Research

Only one proxy task response (“studying”) is confirmed in the conversation. Other interview answers are not collected evidence.

Competitors

Official public websites/docs were scanned; no controlled usability benchmark was performed.

Prototype

Static front-end simulation. No real AI, account connection, data read or message send.

Outcomes

No usability participants, observed findings or quantitative improvements are claimed.

Source access date: 27 October 2026. The case-study structure follows the supplied Pucho.ai UX Mentorship Learning Project brief.